

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4 3  
♥ 5  
♦ 8 6 5 2  
♣ J 10 9 4

♠ 7 5 2

♥ A 10 8

♦ A 9 3

♣ A Q 8 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 8

♥ K Q J 9 6 3

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K Q 6

♥ 7 4 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ K 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♣   | 2 ♥  | Dbl   |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 6NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6NT by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥K     |       |      |       |

West now holds the the only guard in ♠s.

Play the ♦ A, then ♦ K Q.

West will follow to all three ♦s.

Now for the squeeze. Play dummy's ♦ J and discard your ♥ 10.

If West discards the ♠ J you will cash dummy's ♠ 6, then win the last 3 ♣ tricks.

So West will no doubt throw a ♣ instead. In which case you win the last 4 ♣ tricks.

Squeezes are so very satisfying.

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥K.

As usual, you have 11 winners; 3 ♠s, 1 ♥, 4 ♦s and 3 ♣s. If ♠s split 3-3 dummy's ♠ 6 will become trick #12. If ♠s don't split though, you will have the chance of a squeeze if the defender with long ♠s also has 4 or more ♣s.

For a squeeze to operate you will need to lose one trick and the time to do that is right now. Let East hold the ♥K and win his ♥ continuation with your ♥A.

West discarded a ♦ on the second ♥.

You might as well find out about the ♠s right now. Play the ♠ A K Q.

Too bad, East discards a ♥ on the third round of ♠s.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 5 2  
 ♥ A 8 2  
 ♦ Q 8 6 4  
 ♣ K Q 2

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 5

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       | 1 ♦  | Pass  |
| 2NT      | Pass  | 4 ♦  | Pass  |
| 5 ♦      | Pass  | 6 ♦  |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6 ♦ by East

 Lead: ♥K  
 dummy on the third ♦.

East is to play 6 ♦. South leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that South must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from

[showcards N:SQ,HA,H8 E:SJ,S9,H9 S:HJ,H7,D7 W:SK,HQ,HT]

South could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

But when you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

### Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 4 2  
♥ J  
♦ 9 8 4 3  
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J

♥ K 7 3

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 8 6 4

W N  
S E

♠ Q 10 9 3  
♥ 10 5 4  
♦ K J 10  
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 9 8 6 2

♦ Q 7

♣ 7 5 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

1NT

2♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣J

You plan to squeeze East by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to East.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. East is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

East is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

East can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not East.

If you discard the ♦6 East will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, East will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♣J. East wins ♣A K Q then switches to a trump.

East takes ♣A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

East opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and West has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with East and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q 10 6 5

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ -

*West*

1 ♣

3 ♣

4 ♥

6 ♣

All Pass

6 ♣ by West

Lead: ♥K

♠Q is the Vienna Coup.

*North*

Pass

Pass

Pass

*East*

2 ♦

4 ♣

4 ♠

*South*

Pass

Pass

Pass

West is to play 6♣. North leads the ♥K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

North takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦9 which you win with your ♦Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠A before running three rounds of ♣s.

[showcards N:S2,DA,DK,D8 E:SK,DJ,DT,D7  
S:SQ,D5,D4,C7 W:SJ,ST,HQ,D2]

Unblocking the ♠A to create a Threat out of your

As you see, South was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣7 and discard dummy's ♠2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥K.